

NATIONAL TEAM OF THE YEAR

India men's cricket team



Discipline: Cricket

India began the year by retaining the Border-Gavaskar Trophy with a 2-1 series win at home. Along the way, Rohit Sharma's men also qualified for a second successive World Test Championship final, which they eventually lost to Australia. They started the 2023-25 WTC cycle with a 1-0 series win in the West Indies before winning the Asia Cup for a record-extending eighth title. The Men in Blue then went on an inspiring 10-match winning streak in the ODI World Cup before falling short in the final against Australia.

India men's kabaddi team



Discipline: Kabaddi

India beat Iran in a controversial final to reclaim the Asian Games gold after five years and clinch a record-extending eighth title. Earlier, the Indian men's kabaddi team beat Iran 42-32 in a high-voltage final to defend its Asian Championships title. It was India's eighth title in the continental championships.

India men's hockey team



Discipline: Hockey

The Indian men's hockey team clinched the gold medal at the Asian Games, triumphing over Japan in a thrilling final, and earned direct qualification for the Paris Olympics. Adding to its glory, the team claimed the Asian Champions Trophy 2023 title for an unprecedented fourth time. In a historic feat, it also defeated Australia in the FIH Pro League, marking the first such victory in a major competition since 1996. The team continued its winning streak by beating Pakistan in the final of the Asian 5s World Cup qualifiers, earning both the title and a spot in the upcoming FIH Hockey 5s World Cup in 2024. Additionally, it secured a bronze in the 100th Anniversary Spanish Hockey Federation tournament, further solidifying its prowess on the international stage.

India women's U19 team



Discipline: Cricket

Under Shafali Verma's captaincy, India's U-19 side went on to win the World Cup becoming the first women's team — across categories — to win an ICC

title. In the past, the senior team had reached the finals a few times, but all those campaigns had ended in heartbreaks. But this time around, with a spirited young team putting up a brave fight, the girls made the country proud. Later in the year, it also won the U-23 Emerging Asia Cup title.

India women's archery team



Discipline: Compound Archery

Making history on multiple fronts, the trio of Jyothi Surekha Vennam, Aditi Swami, and Parneet Kaur secured India's maiden gold medal at the World Archery Championships. Their stellar performance continued as they triumphed at the Asian Games, clinching the gold in the women's team event by defeating Chinese Taipei in a thrilling final. Not stopping there, the same formidable trio added another feather to the cap by claiming gold in the women's team event at the World Cup Stage 4 in Paris.